DOROTHY AKANKWASA MUHUMURE

Social Development, Education & Policy Advocacy Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dorothy is a highly accomplished Social Development, Education and Advocacy Specialist with more than two decades of progressive experience in policy advocacy, education programming, social protection, gender and disability inclusion, child protection and psychosocial well-being, community engagement, and institutional strengthening across Uganda and the wider East and West African regions, including extensive work in displacement and refugee/host-community contexts.

She holds a Master of Arts in Social Sector Planning and Management and has a strong track record of translating field evidence into high-quality policy briefs, advocacy tools and IEC materials; leading high-level engagement with government ministries (including the Ministry of Education and Sports), Members of Parliament, donor missions and regional institutions; and designing and delivering capacity-building programmes for national institutions, teachers, community structures and civil society.

Her technical grounding in gender-responsive pedagogy, life-skills programming, GBV/SEA prevention and child protection — core building blocks of Social and Emotional Learning — combined with her research, communication and relationship-building strengths, position her to bridge field evidence from displacement contexts with national and regional policy influence. She is detail-oriented, collaborative, and committed to continuous learning and professional development.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- More than two decades of education and social development programming in Uganda and the wider East and West African region, including direct experience with displaced, refugee and host-community learners.
- Sustained high-level engagement with the Ministry of Education and Sports, Members of Parliament, donor missions, national committees and continental platforms (FAWE Africa regional guidelines; gender-responsive pedagogy training delivered across 10 West and Central African countries).
- Strong evidence-generation and documentation record — producing safeguard frameworks, policy briefs, success stories, donor reports and IEC/communication materials used for institutional decision-making.
- Proven design and delivery of capacity-building workshops for teachers, school leadership, community structures, civil society and national institutions.
- Deep technical grounding in gender-responsive pedagogy, life skills, psychosocial well-being and child protection — the foundational components of Social and Emotional Learning.
- Track record mobilising over UGX 21 billion in donor funding and leading evidence-based advocacy campaigns that elevated organisational and policy visibility nationally.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Policy Advocacy, High-Level Lobbying & Government Relations (MoES, MoGLSD, Parliament, Donor Missions)
- Research, Evidence Generation & Policy Brief / Report Development
- Gender-Responsive Pedagogy, Life Skills & Psychosocial Well-being (SEL Foundations)
- Gender, Disability & Social Inclusion Programming
- Child Protection & Safeguarding (PSEAH Investigations, GBV/SEA Prevention)
- Capacity Building, Training Facilitation & Workshop Design
- Stakeholder & Community Engagement (RLOs, CSOs, District Local Governments, School Communities)
- Grants Management, Donor Compliance & Resource Mobilisation
- Monitoring, Evaluation, Documentation & Reporting
- Regional Programming Experience (East, West & Central Africa)

EDUCATION

Institution	Qualification	Year
Makerere University	Master of Arts in Social Sector Planning and Management	2010 – 2014
Makerere University	Bachelor of Arts (Social Sciences) – Economics	1996 – 1999
Immaculate Heart SS, Rukungiri	Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education (UACE)	1994 – 1996
Bishop Comboni College, Kanungu	Uganda Certificate of Education (UCE)	1990 – 1994

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant | **Global Research Administration and Management Service Ltd (GRAMS), Uganda** *2022 – Present*

- Served as consultant for World University Service of Canada (WUSC) to conduct a comprehensive review of the Student Referral Pathways Programme in Uganda and Kenya, leading stakeholder engagement, systems assessment, and strategic recommendations for enhanced integration and service coordination.
- Advised senior leadership teams on policy reform, regulatory compliance, and best-practice frameworks, contributing to improved governance and institutional accountability.
- Provided policy harmonisation and institutional strengthening support to Makerere University Lung Institute (MLI) across multi-research project sites.
- Supported UCS Global Uganda to strengthen grants management systems, including grant agreement review, due diligence, sub-grantee oversight, audit preparedness, and donor compliance.
- Designed and delivered capacity-building programmes in proposal development, financial accountability, donor regulations, and grants management.
- Served as part of the Independent PSEAH Investigators for UNHCR-funded organisations, conducting survivor-centred safeguarding investigations in schools within refugee settlements in Uganda and Kenya.

Social Development Specialist | **Ministry of Education and Sports (MoES) – COVID-19 Education Response Project, Uganda** *2020 – 2021*

- Led the preparation and review of key safeguard instruments, including the Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF), ESMPs, Infection Control and Waste Management Plan, Labour Management Procedure, Stakeholder Engagement Plan, GBV Action Plan, Vulnerable and Marginalised Groups Plan, and the Grievance Redress Mechanism.
- Provided technical guidance to MoES and the Project Coordination Unit to ensure compliance with national legislation and development partner (including World Bank) environmental and social standards.
- Conducted field monitoring missions to verify safeguards implementation during construction, school re-opening, and COVID-19 response activities, documenting gaps and recommending corrective actions.
- Strengthened risk prevention and mitigation measures for SEA/SH, including development of Codes of Conduct, referral pathways, reporting protocols, and community awareness materials.
- Coordinated stakeholder engagements with District Education Offices, school leadership, teacher associations, CSOs, parents, learners, and local authorities to ensure inclusive and meaningful participation.
- Ensured inclusion of vulnerable and marginalised groups — especially girls, children with disabilities, and refugee/host-community learners — in project planning and monitoring activities.
- Worked closely with the Communications Unit to develop and disseminate social safeguard messages at national, regional, district, institutional, and community levels.
- Contributed to quarterly and annual progress reports, including drafting sections on safeguards compliance, risk mitigation, incident reporting, and stakeholder engagement outcomes.

Gender and Disability Specialist | **World Vision Uganda** *2018 – 2019*

- Provided strategic leadership and technical guidance for mainstreaming gender equality and disability inclusion across national programmes, programme designs, M&E frameworks, and organisational policies.
- Led the organisation-wide Gender Assessment that informed the Gender and Disability Inclusion Policy and shaped organisational direction for inclusive programming.

- Developed gender-sensitive and disability-inclusive strategies, guidelines, toolkits, and M&E frameworks to support programme teams in planning, implementation, monitoring, and reporting.
- Built the capacity of staff, partners, and community structures through training in gender analysis, gender-responsive budgeting, disability inclusion, safeguarding, and GBV/SEA prevention.
- Strengthened partnerships with line ministries (MoES, MoGLSD), donors, civil society organisations, UN agencies, and private-sector actors to influence gender-responsive and disability-inclusive policies and resource mobilisation.
- Supported integration of child protection, GBV/SEA prevention, and disability inclusion across community development interventions, with emphasis on girls' education, health, and economic empowerment.
- Developed IEC materials and community awareness messages promoting gender equality, positive masculinity, child protection, and inclusive participation of persons with disabilities.
- Led documentation of gender and disability inclusion best practices, lessons learned, and success stories to inform programme learning and donor reporting.
- Participated in the review of the Re-entry to School Policy, supporting efforts to ensure that learners who had dropped out — particularly adolescent mothers — could return to school and continue their education in a supportive and inclusive environment.
- Contributed to the review of the Gender in Education Policy and the National Strategy for Girls' Education, promoting gender equality, learner protection, prevention of school-related gender-based violence (SRGBV), and the creation of safe and supportive learning environments — strengthening the policy foundation for inclusive, safeguarding-conscious education systems.

Senior Programmes Manager | **Forum for African Women Educationalists (FAWE) Uganda Chapter**
2013 – 2018

- Provided overall leadership and strategic direction for all FAWEU programmes, overseeing financial, technical, operational, and administrative components to ensure high-quality, timely, and impactful programme delivery.
- Led the development, roll-out, and implementation of the FAWEU 2013–2017 Strategic Plan, securing 90% of the total budget requirement through targeted donor engagement and evidence-based proposals.
- Mobilised over UGX 21 billion from major development partners — including Irish Aid, African Development Bank, MasterCard Foundation, and Dubai Cares — by designing strong funding concepts and building strategic alliances.
- Oversaw programme planning, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation across education, gender equality, girls' empowerment, STEM promotion, sexual and reproductive health, and advocacy programmes.
- Strengthened organisational partnerships with national ministries (MoES, MoGLSD), international NGOs, development banks, UN agencies, foundations, and civil society to enhance resource mobilisation and programme impact.
- Provided oversight and technical direction to programme managers, officers, and field teams, ensuring consistent quality standards, donor compliance, and alignment to FAWE's regional frameworks.
- Built and nurtured a high-performing team of 10 national staff and 4 international staff through coaching, performance management, mentorship, and succession planning.
- Led the drafting and institutionalisation of the organisation's Gender Policy, aligned with national gender frameworks and FAWE Africa regional guidelines, and facilitated staff training for organisation-wide adoption.
- Represented FAWEU at high-level national and regional platforms, including government ministries, donor missions, and parliamentary committees, to influence education and gender-related policy dialogues.
- Spearheaded evidence-based advocacy campaigns on girls' education, gender equality, child protection, and youth empowerment, amplifying FAWEU's national profile.
- Championed innovations such as scholarship programme strengthening, mentorship models, gender-responsive pedagogy approaches, and STEM interventions for girls.
- Led documentation of success stories, annual and donor reports, and best-practice publications demonstrating programme outcomes and enhancing organisational visibility.

Programmes Manager | **FAWE Uganda** *2007 – 2013*

- Provided overall leadership and coordination for the Programmes Department, ensuring high-quality planning, implementation, monitoring, and reporting of education and gender-focused interventions across multiple districts.

- Co-led the development of the FAWEU 2013–2017 Strategic Plan, ensuring alignment with national education priorities, FAWE regional strategies, and donor interests.
- Oversaw the development and integration of Monitoring & Evaluation frameworks, supporting project officers to track results and generate evidence for learning and donor reporting.
- Represented FAWEU on key national committees — including the National Gender Taskforce and the Makerere University Female Scholarship Foundation Board — to influence national education and gender policies.
- Contributed to resource mobilisation through the design of proposals, concept notes, and donor presentations that secured funding for scholarships, STEM, advocacy, and empowerment programmes.
- Built the capacity of programme teams, district partners, school leaders, and community structures in gender-responsive pedagogy, life skills, child protection, and monitoring and evaluation.
- Led the design and implementation of gender-focused education programmes addressing barriers to girls' education, including mentorship, scholarships, SRHR awareness, and community mobilisation.
- Contributed to the design and implementation of the Higher Education Access Program, a bridging initiative enabling students who narrowly missed university admission cut-off points to undertake a one-year preparatory programme before progressing into degree studies — a model whose demonstrated effectiveness influenced its adoption by other universities and expanded access to higher education.

Programmes Officer | **FAWE Uganda** *2003 – 2007*

- Supported the design, planning, and execution of FAWEU education and gender-focused programmes, ensuring alignment with organisational priorities and donor requirements.
- Supervised day-to-day programme implementation and ensured timely preparation of high-quality reports to management, the FAWE Regional Secretariat, and donors.
- Coordinated district-level engagement with schools, district education offices, community leaders, teachers, and parents to strengthen support systems for girls' education.
- Developed and delivered training packages for teachers, community facilitators, and learners on life skills, gender roles, hygiene and sanitation, youth empowerment, HIV/AIDS awareness, and child protection.
- Contributed to the successful implementation of a 10-year USAID-funded scholarship programme, supporting identification, selection, mentorship, and monitoring of beneficiaries across multiple regions.

Project Assistant | **AMREF – Water and Sanitation Project (Rukungiri, Kanungu, Kabale Districts)** *2000 – 2003*

- Mobilised schools, communities, local councils, and district officials to participate in planning and implementation of Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) interventions, ensuring community ownership and sustainability.
- Facilitated community engagement processes, including meetings, sensitisation drives, and trainings on hygiene promotion and sanitation practices.
- Conducted continuous behaviour-change sensitisation campaigns using drama, school clubs, home visits, and community dialogues to promote safe hygiene practices.
- Strengthened collaboration with district water and health offices, school management committees, teachers, and community leaders to coordinate implementation and ensure sustainability of interventions.

OTHER CONSULTANCY ASSIGNMENTS

- **2024 – FAWE Uganda (Ntoroko District):** Facilitated training on the establishment of Gender Responsive Pedagogy (GRP) in 23 schools.
- **2022 – FAWE West Africa:** Conducted a 5-day training on GRP centres of excellence in 10 West and Central African countries.
- **2021 – FAWE Uganda:** Facilitated national training on Gender Responsive Pedagogy for institutions of higher learning.
- **2020 – FAWE Uganda:** Supervised research on the impact of COVID-19 on school-going girls and young women.

SPECIALISED ROLES & CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Gender-Responsive Pedagogy (GRP) Toolkit Trainer

- Certified GRP Toolkit Trainer with extensive experience training and coaching educators in primary, secondary, and higher institutions of learning.
- Facilitated capacity-building workshops on gender-responsive teaching and learning practices, inclusive classroom management, learner participation, safeguarding, and the creation of equitable learning environments — foundational components of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL).
- Supported schools and higher education institutions to integrate gender-responsive approaches that enhance student engagement, retention, academic achievement, and well-being.
- Equipped teachers and education leaders with practical skills to identify and address barriers to learning, particularly those affecting girls and vulnerable and displaced learners.

Mentor and Youth Development Practitioner

- Seasoned mentor supporting adolescent girls and young women through structured mentorship programmes implemented by Girls 4 Girls Uganda and FAWE Uganda, including a six-month, six-session curriculum covering building trust, courageous leadership, communication, negotiation and self-advocacy, public service, and ethics in decision-making.
- Provided guidance on personal development, leadership, life skills, career planning, self-esteem, decision-making, and resilience building.
- Facilitated mentorship sessions focused on social-emotional learning, psychosocial well-being, academic success, and transition to higher education and employment opportunities.
- Worked closely with schools, communities, parents, and other stakeholders to strengthen support systems for young people.

REFEREES

Mr. Twinomukunzi Malcolm Mpamizo

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CERTIFICATION

I, the undersigned, certify that to the best of my knowledge and belief, the information provided in this CV is accurate and complete.

Signed: Dorothy Akankwasa Muhumure